# Science on the Court — Code of Conduct

Djola, LLC dba Science on the Court · Adopted November 4, 2026 · Required of every employee, contracted instructor, and volunteer before beginning any SOTC role (Operations Policy Manual §3.2). Section numbers refer to the Manual.

### 1. Child safety comes first

I will follow the child-protection policies in Manual §4. I will never be alone with a participant (§4.1); I will keep doors open or sight lines clear; and I will never transport a participant in a personal vehicle. SOTC has zero tolerance for physical, emotional, or sexual abuse of any participant (§4.2).

### 2. Physical contact

Appropriate contact is limited, in view of others, with the participant's consent, and for an instructional or safety purpose: high-fives, fist bumps, handshakes, shoulder or upper-back pats, and brief spotting or guidance in a drill after I explain and ask first. I will not kiss, give full-frontal or prolonged hugs, allow lap-sitting, wrestle, tickle, give piggyback rides, touch private areas, or use physical punishment (§4.3).

### 3. Professional boundaries and communication

- I will communicate with participants and parents only through official SOTC channels, never personal phone, email, or social media accounts. I will not friend or follow current participants on personal accounts or post their images or information (§4.5).
- Any individual message to a participant will be copied to a parent or the Executive Director and limited to program matters.
- No relationships with participants outside SOTC programs: no babysitting, private tutoring or coaching, home visits, meals, travel, or gifts given or received.
- I will use appropriate language only: no shaming, profanity, off-color jokes, requests to keep secrets, or inappropriate personal disclosures.

### 4. Mandatory reporting

I am a mandated reporter under California law. I will report any suspicion of child abuse or neglect directly to law enforcement or Child Protective Services as the law requires, and also to SOTC's Child Safety Officer (the Executive Director). Reporting internally never replaces or delays my legal report. I will report observed policy violations to the Site Lead or Executive Director, and I understand that retaliation against a good-faith reporter is prohibited (§4.4).

### 5. Confidentiality

I will keep participant, family, and host-site information confidential and share it only with those who need it to run the program. I will not release emergency or incident information to media or anyone outside SOTC and the authorities (§3.4, §4.6).

### 6. Ethical behavior and non-discrimination

I will treat every participant, family, colleague, and host-site staff member with respect, without discrimination or harassment on any basis. I will be honest in my records, attendance, time, and invoices. I will disclose to the Executive Director any conflict of interest, including any outside relationship with a participant's family or a host site.

### 7. Substances and fitness for duty

I will not possess, use, or be under the influence of alcohol, cannabis, or illegal drugs during any SOTC activity or while on a host site. Smoking and vaping are not permitted on school or program grounds.

### 8. Screening and training

I will complete the screening in Manual §3.3 and the training in Manual §6 before participant contact, keep them current, and self-report any arrest, charge, or conviction that occurs while I serve with SOTC (§3.6).

### 9. Consequences

A violation of this Code may result in removal from participant contact, termination of my employment, contract, or volunteer role, and, where required, a report to authorities. I understand that an allegation of abuse results in immediate removal from participant contact pending investigation.

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Name (print) _____ Role · Site(s) _____

Signature _____ Date _____

Retain in the personnel file permanently (Manual §5.6a). Pairs with the Personnel Packet acknowledgments page.